

FOREWORD

Flipping through these pages is an odd experience. It is amazing how quick the human mind is to forget the journey, no matter how arduous. Picture has just locked, and I am currently in a phase of filmmaking most easily equated to "firing the ceramic pot." I am putting the finishing touches onto sound, picture, and digital effects. As I write this, I have no idea if we've succeeded in what we've set out to do. Taking a rare moment to look back on how far we've come, however, makes me quite proud of our effort and sincerity.

These images reveal a journey taken by countless talented and hardworking artists and craftsmen. Their work as individuals is, by its very nature, invisible. Like in a Japanese rock garden, the artist's final job is to rake away their footprints and create the illusion that the garden was untouched by human hands. Film, however, is extremely human. Make no mistake, no matter how many computers are used, each frame is truly handmade. This book serves to give a glimpse of all the fingerprints that have been buffed away in the interest of creating an illusion. I dedicate this book to those who have contributed and sacrificed to tell a story and entertain. It is a noble endeavor.

—JON FAVREAU